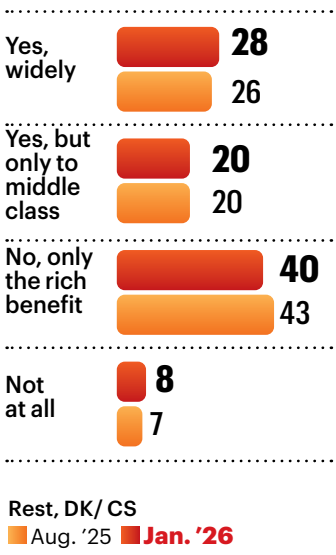
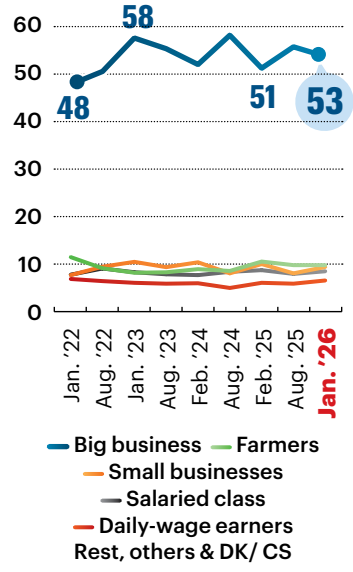
Q. Do you believe the benefits of India's economic growth are reaching the common people?



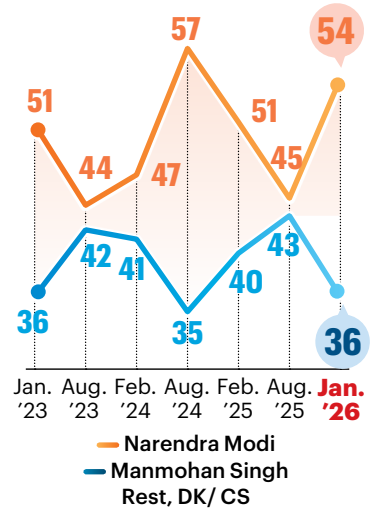
Most say the Centre's policies benefit the rich, but fewer hold this view than before

Q. Who do you think has benefited the most from the NDA government's economic policies?



Perceptions that big businesses benefit from govt policies remain persistent

Q. Who, in your opinion, has better managed the overall Indian economy?



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PER CENT
of the respondents in the Northeast say the Modi govt has created many jobs, while 45% in the East and 43% in the North say it has not

Changes in direct tax slabs meant those earning up to Rs 12 lakh (Rs 12.75 lakh for salaried taxpayers, after standard deduction) paid no income tax, benefiting an estimated 32 million taxpayers. Alongside, major GST reform in late September cut taxes on 90 per cent of essential goods. These moves were reinforced by RBI rate cuts of 125 basis points in 2025—the steepest monetary easing since 2019.

The MOTN survey suggests a modest shift in perceptions of growth's reach. About 28 per cent say the benefits are 'widely' reaching the commoners, up from 26.3 per cent earlier. Another 19.5 per cent feel gains have accrued mainly to the middle class. Still, 39.6 per cent believe government policies benefit only the rich, though this view has eased from 42.5 per cent previously.

A large segment (53 per cent) still feel that big business gains disproportionately from the Centre's economic policies. While this is down from 55.8 per cent earlier, the figure has remained above 50 per cent in every MOTN survey since August 2022. The Congress party's repeated attacks over an alleged nexus between big business and the government appear to have reinforced this perception.

For much of 2025, inflation stayed near the lower end of the RBI's target band (2-4 per cent) as food prices eased. Yet concerns over rising household expenses persist: 63.2 per cent say current costs are difficult to manage, up from 60.6 per cent previously. Another 27.9 per cent feel expenses have risen but are still manageable. Lower GST has not altered consumption behaviour for 48.9 per cent of the respondents, while only 22.6 per cent say they are spending more—suggesting consumers are waiting for a sustained cooling of prices before changing their buying patterns.

THE JOBS CHALLENGE

Jobs continue to be a recurring concern in the MOTN poll. After securing a third term, the Modi government in July 2024 announced a prime minister's package of five schemes aimed at creating employment, skilling and opportunities for 41 million youth over five years, with a central outlay of Rs 2 lakh crore. While the plan was earnest, implementation has been sluggish. A combined 64.8 per cent of the respondents

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say